

X-MEN



Disgusted with Magneto, the Scarlet Witch removed 90 per cent of the world's mutants on November 2.

M-DAY

One of the world's most powerful mutants, the SCARLET WITCH, had a breakdown, during which she tore apart the team with which she worked: the Avengers. Later, as the X-Men discussed the Scarlet Witch's fate, her brother, QUICKSILVER, encouraged her to use her powers to remake the world. At her bidding thousands more people became mutants, and her father, MAGNETO, ruled the planet as the leader of the House of M. To keep others from looking too closely at their new reality, she gave them whatever they wanted: respectability, money, love, power.

Once the Scarlet Witch had been made to realize what she'd done, she changed everything back to normal—with a few twists. Among these were the fact that 90 per cent of the world's mutants lost their powers, including Magneto, Professor X, and herself.

THE AFTERMATH

With the mutant population decimated, the US government estimated that 198 mutants were left with their powers intact. The Office of National Emergency (ONE) under Valerie COOPER moved to gather these mutants at the Xavier Mansion and keep them there, guarded by SENTINELS.

This lasted until the Civil War (see pp.84–5), during which the X-Men officially remained neutral. As the war progressed, the restrictions on the mutants living at the X Mansion were lifted, with the Sentinels left in place to guard the residents from outside attacks.

The power of the mutants had been stripped from them, but it could not be destroyed. Many of the powers banded into a being known as the Collective, which possessed mutant Michael Pointer (GUARDIAN) and used him to cut a swathe of destruction across North America. The Collective then traveled to Genosha to converse

with Magneto before racing off into space.

As it left the planet, it brushed past Krakoa—the island-sized mutant that nearly killed the original

X-Men—and awakened the missing Summers brother, Gabriel (VULCAN). Gabriel returned to Earth and, after killing BANSHEE, revealed that he had been part of a team of young mutants sent to save the original X-Men from Krakoa. After they had all been apparently killed, Professor X had erased the memory of their existence. Learning this, Cyclops informed the professor that he would no longer be welcome with his X-Men.



As the Collective, Michael Pointer and Xorn slaughtered Alpha Flight, repowered Magneto, and awakened Vulcan.



INTERPLANETARY PROBLEMS

Trying to make up for his mistakes, Professor X led a team of X-Men—including DARWIN, HAVOK, NIGHTCRAWLER, POLARIS, RACHEL SUMMERS, and WARPATH—into space to stop Vulcan. They failed to keep Vulcan from killing his father, Corsair, but they and the rest of the STARJAMMERS rescued LILANDRA. After Xavier regained his powers, he and half the team returned to Earth, leaving the others to form a new Starjammers to stand against Vulcan, who had become the new ruler of the Shi'ar Empire.

The other X-Men, under Cyclops, traveled to the planet Breakworld, where its leader was preparing to fire a gigantic missile at the Earth, large enough to destroy the planet. Kitty Pryde phased into the missile to try to defuse it but discovered it was actually a solid bullet. Using all her might, she managed to phase the bullet through Earth, but she remained trapped inside of it and is now presumed dead.

When the HULK returned to Earth to have his revenge on the ILLUMINATI, he went to the X Mansion to confront Xavier. After a pitched battle, the Hulk learned about all of the horrible things that had happened to the mutants in his absence and concluded that they had suffered plenty as a people.



Professor X's X-Men consisted of Vulcan, Sway, Petra, and Darwin. They were lost fighting Krakoa.

MESSIAH COMPLEX

It looked like there would be no more mutants to join the 198 or so left on the planet. While using his Cerebra mutant-finding machine, though, Professor X spotted one amazingly powerful new mutant in Cooperstown, Alaska, and Cyclops led a team of X-Men to investigate. The anti-mutant militants known as the Purifiers, and MR. SINISTER's new team of MARAUDERS, beat the X-Men there.

The Purifiers, realizing that they were looking for a young mutant, killed every child in town, even the infants still in the hospital. This tipped the X-Men—along with X-FACTOR and the YOUNG X-MEN—off to the fact that the first mutant since M-Day had been born—and manifested its powers at birth. They later learned that Cable had gotten there first and taken the baby to safety.

Meanwhile, Predator X, a monster the Purifiers had created to destroy the "Mutant Anti-Christ," found the baby's scent and began killing mutants to sate its hunger as it tracked the infant down. While many X-Men were out hunting for the baby, the Nano-Sentinels infected the human pilots of the Sentinels assigned to guard the mansion. They attacked, nearly destroying the place. In response to this, Cyclops formed an all-new X-Force as a black-ops team. **MF**



Gambit joined Mr. Sinister's new Marauders—not to help with their plans but to advance his own.



The US government agency ONE positioned Sentinels around the X-Mansion to keep hostile humans out—and the mutants in.